

Rating Rationale

April 24, 2026 | Mumbai

Sheela Foam Limited

Rating outlook revised to 'Positive'; Rating Reaffirmed

Rating Action

Total Bank Loan Facilities Rated	Rs.163.27 Crore
Long Term Rating	Crisil AA-/Positive (Outlook revised from 'Stable'; Rating Reaffirmed)

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1 crore = 10 million

Refer to Annexure for Details of Instruments & Bank Facilities

Detailed Rationale

Crisil Ratings has revised its outlook on the long-term bank facilities of Sheela Foam Limited (SFL) to '**Positive**' from '**Stable**' while reaffirming the rating at '**Crisil AA-**'.

The revision in the outlook factors in the improvement in the business risk profile of SFL as witnessed by successful integration with Kurlon Enterprise Ltd (KEL) and its market leadership position in the mattress and foam segment providing strong impetus for healthy growth in revenues and expansion in profitability. The revision in outlook also factors in strengthening of financial risk profile with continuous deleveraging.

Consolidated revenues increased by 7% year on year to Rs.2771 crores driven by healthy volume growth in 9m-FY26 despite some moderation in realizations owing soft raw material costs. SFL has opened 600 retail showrooms till Dec 2025 with a target of 700 retail showrooms in fiscal 2026 as a strategy to maintain and expand their market share. With prices of crude linked raw materials on the rise since past couple of months, realizations are also expected to increase as company has taken calibrated price hikes. Consequently, revenue growth is expected to be stronger next fiscal driven by a combination of healthy volume growth and improved realizations.

Operating margins have improved to 10% in the first nine months of fiscal 2026 compared to 8.4% in same period previous fiscal despite forex and mark to market losses on investments during the period. With realization of 80% of the synergy benefits from KEL acquisition, recent price hikes being undertaken, along with improving share from higher margin mattress division, operating margins are expected to improve further going forward. Working capital cycle to remain comfortable with debtor and inventory days staying at 35-40 days each.

Financial risk profile has strengthened with substantial reduction in debt resulting in improvement in capital structure and debt protection metrics. As of April 2026, SFL has repaid 3/4th for the debt taken in the form of Non-Convertible Debentures to fund the acquisition of KEL. With this residual acquisition debt expected to be completely retired by October 2026, gearing may improve to below 0.15 times and interest coverage at over 10 times going forward. Liquidity also remains healthy supported by cash surplus of Rs.110 crores as of April 2026, low bank limits utilisation, healthy accruals and some core assets which could be liquidated as required.

The ratings continue to be driven by the established market position of SFL and its diversified geographic presence and revenue profile and the strong financial risk profile of the SFL group. The strengths are partially offset by susceptibility to volatility in input prices and competition from the unorganised segment.

Analytical Approach

Crisil Ratings has combined the business and financial risk profiles of SFL and its subsidiaries as all the entities, collectively referred to as the SFL group, are in the same business, and SFL has managerial control over all the entities.

Please refer Annexure - List of Entities Consolidated, which captures the list of entities considered and their analytical treatment of consolidation.

Key Rating Drivers - Strengths

Established market position in the modern mattress business

SFL is the largest producer of flexible slab stock polyurethane (PU) foam and mattresses in India. Post-acquisition of KEL, the second-largest player in the mattress segment, SFL has a combined share of 29% in the modern mattress market, along with its well-established brands, Sleepwell and Kurlon. The product range includes mattresses, pillows, cushioning material, and specialized foams. A pan-India distribution network facilitates access to retail and industrial customers. Gradual shift from the unorganised to organised sector, backed by growing consumer awareness about health benefits of using quality mattresses, has helped the company gain market share.

Healthy revenue diversity

The revenue profile is diversified in terms of product segments and geographical reach. Though mattresses continue to be a dominant revenue contributor, the SFL group also has significant presence in retail and industrial foam products. Apart from furniture cushioning, the group sells flexible slab stock PU foam to manufacturers of automotive seats, footwear and clothing. SFL has also made a strategic investment of 43.05% in the House of Keiraya – Furlenco in the last two years, which primarily rents and also sells furniture; an allied business to SFL.

Furthermore, the group is present in Australia, through Joyce Foam Pty Ltd (JFPL), the largest local player (40% market share) in the foam business, and the European Union through Interplasp, which operates from Spain.

The Australian and Spanish businesses accounted for 23% of revenue in fiscal 2025. Healthy geographical diversity in revenue shall benefit operations over the medium term and protect the company from any regional disruptions.

SFL has a strong presence in northern and western India, whereas KEL has major presence in eastern and southern India. Acquisition of KEL will thus, help SFL widen its overall geographic reach.

Comfortable financial risk profile

The financial risk profile is marked by a healthy capital structure, improving debt protection metrics and adequate liquidity. Tangible networth is expected to remain healthy over Rs.2500 crores in the medium term with comfortable accretion to reserves. The debt payment is on track with the debt expected to reduce to Rs.555 crores in fiscal 2026 from Rs.1283 crores in the previous fiscal. The same is expected to reduce further with the balance NCD repayment of Rs.361 crores raised for KEL acquisition in fiscal 2027.

The gearing is expected to remain healthy at below 0.1 times in the medium term. Interest coverage is likely to improve to over 5 times in fiscal 2026 from 2.7 times in fiscal 2025 and further to over 10 times in the medium term with decreasing interest burden.

Key Rating Drivers - Weaknesses

Susceptibility to volatility in input prices

Raw material cost forms a significant portion of overall manufacturing cost (60-65%). The key raw materials, polyol and toluene diisocyanate (TDI), are manufactured from by-products of crude oil, and their prices are linked to crude oil prices and prevailing demand-supply conditions. Prices have fluctuated sharply in the past few years. However, the company managed to achieve higher gross margin through bulk discounts on purchases, improvement in yields, material substitution and use of innovative technologies such as variable pressure foam (VPF), and other input material rationalisation. Sustenance of the same would lead to greater profitability.

With heightened geo-political conflict in Middle East, SFL's ability to pass on the increase in raw material prices to consumers and maintain a healthy margin remains a key monitorable. The raw material price fluctuations are usually readily passed on to the institutional customers in the foam segment, while it is more gradual in the mattress segment as their retail price increases are generally kept calibrated with competitors.

Operating margin was impacted in FY25 (7.3%) as the lower-margin business of KEL was consolidated with SFL. SFL has adopted various initiatives on both higher sales realisations and cost control to gradually reduce the gap in operating profitability between both the companies which is likely to improve the overall profitability of the company over the medium term.

Exposure to intense competition from unorganized players and new age players and threat of substitutes

SFL faces intense competition from unorganized players, which forms more than 50% of the mattress market in India. Furthermore, new-age players on e-commerce platforms add strong competition. The ability to maintain the market share across a range of products amid intense competition will remain a rating sensitivity factor. Further, growing environmental awareness and available sustainable solutions are paving way for bio-based foam alternatives to PU foams such as soy-based sustainable foams, polyolefin foams, and latex etc. In the current market scenario with sharp increase in the prices of raw materials, organized players like SFL are better positioned to gain market share from them as unorganized players find it difficult to navigate price increase absorption in the market while simultaneously managing to contain increase in their working capital requirements.

Liquidity Strong

Apart from adequate cash accrual, liquidity will be also aided by cash & liquid investment balances of Rs.110 crores in April 2026. Bank limit of Rs 1000 crore remains moderately utilised at 6% over the 6 months ended Jan 31, 2026.

Outlook Positive

Crisil Ratings believes SFL will continue to benefit from its strong market position and likely advantages from consolidation of both entities along with the strengthening of financial risk profile with the anticipated debt reduction.

Rating sensitivity factors**Upward factors**

- Improvement in business risk profile with operating profitability improving to over 11% on a sustained basis
- Sustenance of robust financial risk profile with ample liquidity

Downward factors

- Significant decline in operating margin to less than 8-9% on a sustained basis
- Weakening of the capital structure because of incremental debt, stretched working capital cycle or pressure on liquidity

About the Company

SFL, promoted by the late Ms Sheela Gautam, commenced commercial production of PU foam at its factory in Sahibabad, Uttar Pradesh in 1971. It has 12 manufacturing units, which includes 5 units for PU-foam facilities, with combined capacity of 1,39,000 tonne per annum (TPA), across India including 10,000 TPA for Jabalpur plant, which got commenced in December 2023. The company sells foam, coir and spring mattresses under the Sleepwell brand and non-mattress foam products under the Feather Foam brand. The promoters hold ~65.69% shareholding in the SFL.

JFPL, acquired by SFL in 2005, is the largest player in the PU foam business in Australia. It manufactures polyester, reticulated, viscoelastic and memory foam, while using VPF technology. It caters to furniture and automobile seat manufacturers and the bedding industry. Currently, it has foaming capacity of 17,000 TPA.

In December 2016, SFL completed its initial public offering, wherein the promoters diluted 14.32% of their stake. Shares on sale were offloaded by Polyflex Marketing Pvt Ltd, a company held by the promoters.

In October 2019, SFL acquired Interplasp. Established in 1987, Interplasp specialises in manufacturing flexible PU foams using VPF technology and mainly supplies to mattress and furniture manufacturers in Spain. It also markets to mattress manufacturers in Portugal and foam convertors in Morocco. It has a single facility with capacity of 22,000 TPA.

In October 2023, the company also acquired 35% stake in House of Kieraya (HOK) – Furlenco which was further increased to 43.05% in Dec 2025. Furlenco was founded in 2012 by Mr. Ajith Mohan Karimpana. It is today one of the fastest growing furniture companies in India and is a tech-driven business. The company operates under the brand name Furlenco.

SFL has an incremental voting right in Furlenco of up to 50.01% even when the company acquired 35% stake in the company. The incremental voting right remains unchanged even though the company has acquired additional stake in Furlenco. The incremental stake of 50.01% will remain till the time SFL acquires up to 50.01% stake in Furlenco.

Key Financial Indicators (consolidated; Crisil Ratings-adjusted figures)

Particulars	Unit	2025	2024
		Actual	Actual
Revenue	Rs crore	3,493	3,057
Profit after tax (PAT)	Rs crore	97	181
PAT margin	%	2.8	5.9
Adjusted gearing	Times	0.6	0.5
Interest coverage	Times	2.7	5.6

Any other information: Not applicable

Note on complexity levels of the rated instrument:

Crisil Ratings' complexity levels are assigned to various types of financial instruments and are included (where applicable) in the 'Annexure - Details of Instrument' in this Rating Rationale.

Crisil Ratings will disclose complexity level for all securities - including those that are yet to be placed - based on available information. The complexity level for instruments may be updated, where required, in the rating rationale published subsequent to the issuance of the instrument when details on such features are available.

For more details on the Crisil Ratings' complexity levels please visit www.crisilratings.com. Users may also call the Customer Service Helpdesk with queries on specific instruments.

Annexure - Details of Instrument(s)

ISIN	Name Of Instrument	Date Of Allotment	Coupon Rate (%)	Maturity Date	Issue Size (Rs. Crore)	Complexity Levels	Rating Outstanding with Outlook
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NA	Cash Credit ^{&}	NA	NA	NA	72.00	NA	Crisil AA-/Positive
NA	Working Capital Demand Loan ^{&}	NA	NA	NA	91.27	NA	Crisil AA-/Positive

& - Fully fungible with non-fund-based facilities

Annexure – List of entities consolidated

Name of entities consolidated	Extent of consolidation	Rationale for consolidation
Joyce Foam Pty Ltd (Australia)	Full	Strong managerial operational and financial linkages
Staqa Software Solutions Pvt Ltd	Full	Strong managerial, operational and financial linkages
Sleepwell Enterprises Pvt Ltd	Full	Strong managerial, operational and financial linkages
International Foam Technologies SL, Spain	Full	Strong managerial, operational and financial linkages
Staqa Inc (U.S.A)	Full	Strong managerial, operational and financial linkages
Staqa Technologies LLC	Full	Strong managerial, operational and financial linkages
Joyce WC NSW Pty Ltd (Australia)	Full	Strong managerial, operational and financial linkages
Interplasp SL (Spain)	Full	Strong managerial, operational and financial linkages

Annexure - Rating History for last 3 Years

Instrument	Current			2026 (History)		2025		2024		2023		Start of 2023
	Type	Outstanding Amount	Rating	Date	Rating	Date	Rating	Date	Rating	Date	Rating	Rating
Fund Based Facilities	LT	163.27	Crisil AA-/Positive		--	05-03-25	Crisil AA-/Stable		--	31-10-23	Crisil AA-/Positive / Crisil A1+	Crisil AA-/Stable / Crisil A1+
			--		--	28-01-25	Crisil AA-/Stable / Crisil A1+		--	25-08-23	Crisil AA-/Watch Positive / Crisil A1+	--
			--		--		--		--	26-07-23	Crisil AA-/Watch Developing / Crisil A1+	--
			--		--		--		--	23-02-23	Crisil AA-/Stable / Crisil A1+	--

All amounts are in Rs.Cr.

Annexure - Details of Bank Lenders & Facilities

Facility	Amount (Rs.Crore)	Name of Lender	Rating
Cash Credit ^{&}	72	Citibank N. A.	Crisil AA-/Positive
Working Capital Demand Loan ^{&}	91.27	YES Bank Limited	Crisil AA-/Positive

& - Fully fungible with non-fund-based facilities

Annexure: List of instruments and names of regulators of the instruments

As required by SEBI CRA Circular dated Feb 10, 2026, a list of activities or instruments falling under the purview of various FSRs, along with the names of respective FSRs, is being disclosed below:

A. Rating activities

Sr. No.	Instrument / activity Name	Regulator of the instruments
1	Listed/Proposed to be listed bonds/debentures/preference share (all securities)	SEBI

2	Unlisted/Proposed to be unlisted Bonds/Debentures/ Preference share (all securities)	MCA
3	Listed PTCs / Securitisation Notes (originated by entities regulated by RBI)*	SEBI
4	Listed PTCs / Securitisation Notes (originated by entities not regulated by RBI)*	SEBI
5	Unlisted PTCs / Securitisation Notes (originated by entities regulated by RBI)*	RBI
6	Listed Commercial Paper and NCDs with original maturity less than 1 year	RBI
7	Unlisted Commercial Paper and NCDs with original maturity less than 1 year	RBI
8	Loan Facilities (Fund/Non-Fund Based) from Bank/NBFCs/NHB/FIs ^	RBI
9	External Commercial Borrowings and other similar borrowings	RBI
10	Certificates of Deposit	RBI
11	Fixed Deposits raised by NBFC's, Banks, HFCs, Fis	RBI
12	Fixed Deposits raised by corporates other than NBFCs, Banks, HFCs, Fis	MCA
13	Inter Corporate Deposits/Loans extended by Corporates	MCA
14	Borrowing programme ~	-
15	Issuer Ratings #	-
16	Credit Ratings for Capital Protection Oriented Schemes (by Mutual Funds and AIFs)	SEBI
17	Credit quality ratings (CQRs) for Mutual Fund Schemes and Schemes of AIFs	SEBI
18	Listed Security Receipts	SEBI
19	Unlisted Security Receipts	RBI
20	Independent Credit Evaluation (ICE)	RBI
21	Expected Loss Ratings (for Loan Facilities (Fund/Non-Fund Based) from Bank/NBFCs/NHB/Fis)	RBI
22	Expected Loss Ratings (Listed/Proposed to be listed bonds/debentures/preference share (all securities))	SEBI
23	Expected Loss Ratings (Unlisted/Proposed to be unlisted Bonds/Debentures/ Preference share (all securities))	MCA
24	Unlisted PTCs / Securitisation Notes (originated by entities not regulated by RBI) *	Investor-side regulator such as IRDAI, PFRDA @

* Includes securitisation transactions involving assignee payout, acquirer's payout.

~ The rated instrument may involve issuance of different instruments such as debt securities (listed or otherwise), bank loans, commercial paper (listed or otherwise), etc. The regulator of the instrument may accordingly be SEBI, RBI or MCA and can only be determined upon issuance. In PRs subsequent to issuance(s), Crisil Ratings Limited shall separately capture the rated quantum details along with names of respective regulators.

^ Includes bank facilities such as liquidity facility, second loss facility that are part of securitisation transactions.

There is no instrument being rated and hence, Regulator of the Instrument is not applicable. The rating scale and definitions are being followed as stipulated in SEBI Master Circular for CRAs.

@ These ratings were assigned during regulatory regime prior to introduction of SEBI CRA Circular dated Feb 10, 2026 and the investor side regulators have accordingly been included.

Note: Kindly note that for activities or instruments falling under the purview of FSRs other than SEBI, the grievance/dispute redressal mechanisms and investor protection mechanisms provided by SEBI shall not be available.

Criteria Details

Links to related criteria

[Basics of Ratings \(including default recognition, assessing information adequacy\)](#)

[Criteria for consolidation](#)

[Criteria for manufacturing, trading and corporate services sector \(including approach for financial ratios\)](#)

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